

Decision Maker		
You are looking for	An MP3 player that is compact and allows you to store up to 2 hours of music	A portable solution that lets you store 10 hours worth of music
You need	A solid state MP3 player that lets you transfer MP3 files from your computer via a USB connection	A portable player that supports CD, CD-R and CD-RW media and a CD-Writer to burn the MP3s
Look for	Creative PA-20 and M-ANY DAH200S	NAPA DAV316 and Creative DAP-CD0001
Price range	Rs 6,000 to Rs 9,000	Rs 5,500 to Rs 9,000

usage. Philips is the only brand to have a staggering 174 service centres across 196 cities in India. The Creative DAP-CD0001 came in at a distant second with 18 service centres spread across 18 cities. Except for the M-ANY DAH200S and NAPA DAV316, all the players came with a one-year carry-in warranty.

The Last Note

The arrival of compression algorithms like MP3 and WMA has heralded a new era in portable music. MP3 players now offer a range and quality so diverse that there is something for every one who likes to jive to the odd beat or two. We have compact, solid-state portables for the travellers, while CD-based players offer an amazing amount of storage space, making carrying your entire music collection within just one single device a distinct possibility. And our tests show that the quality of audio offered by most of these MP3 players is good enough to satisfy even the most discriminating audiophile.

The **Creative PA-20** that was priced at Rs 6,325, won our Best Performance Award, scoring an impressive 18.4 points out of 20 in the features test. The PA-20 also did very well in the audio quality tests, scoring full points for both the English and the Hindi tracks. The fidelity of the musical instruments and the clarity of vocals that it offered remained unmatched to a great extent. It also comes with an in-built memory of 32 MB, which can be upgraded with the help of a MultiMediaCard.



Although small in size the Creative PA-20 packs a mean punch

for the low price of Rs 5,650, it is a solution within the reach of almost everyone. 

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